historical *vis-à-vis* each battle. Unlike the legions of the Roman Empire, the legions of the Punic-era republic were usually raised anew each year, and thus there was little continuity. However, we have differentiated the skill levels of these eight legions, both as required by the scenarios and, also, to enable the players to experiment a little. We have, correspondingly, done the same with the alae, although there are no "crack" alae and the differences between the skill levels are not so pronounced. The skill levels are as follows:

- Crack/Elite: I Legion
- Veteran: X Legion/Ala, I Ala
- Standard: III, V Legions/Alae
- Recruits: VII, XIV, XV and XIX Legions/Alae

Legion units have their Legion number printed on the counter: e.g., III. Alae Sociorum units have an "AS" in addition to their number: e.g., AS/XIX.

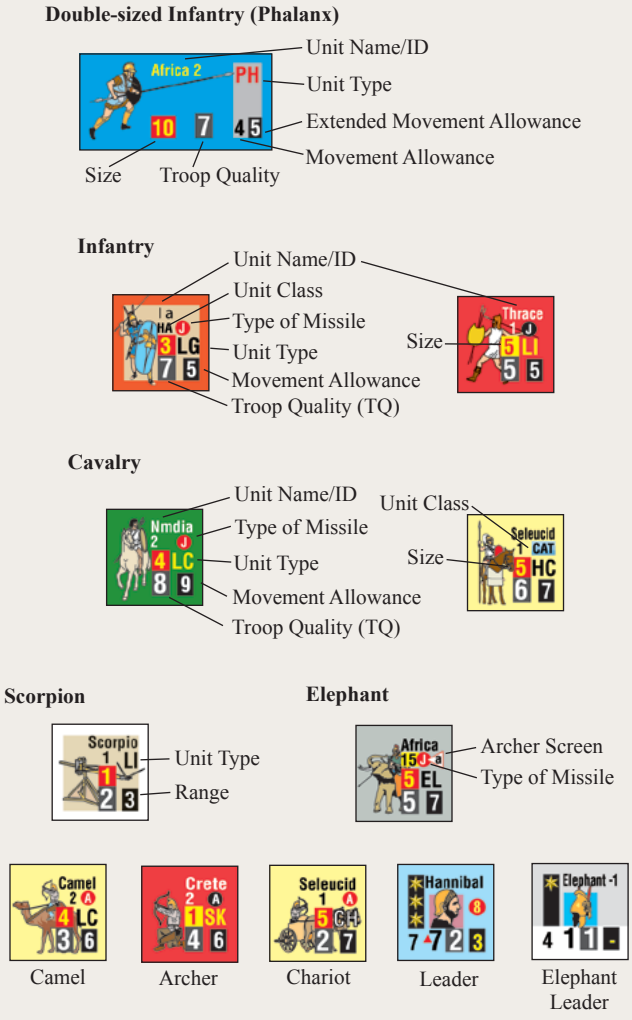
Each legion and its corresponding ala has the same, individualized, colored border; this will make identification easier when implementing the Roman stacking rules.

2.24 Legion Units. This period of history finds the legion—and the units that make up its maniples—in transition, both in terms of what the men fought with and how the units were used. For example, it appears that the change from spears to throwing javelins (pila) for the bulk of legionary infantry was not abrupt. Nor was it total. Thus, you find references to some Principes units with pila and some with spears. Certainly, by the time of Scipio—and then Marius and Caesar—the Principes had become virtually indistinguishable from the Hastati. And then there's the question of Roman cavalry. Polybius says they were armed in the "Greek" style, which would make them heavy cavalry; however, Polybius also points out that they were armed only with small shields and spears—not exactly heavy cavalry. To say that hundreds of historians have taken a crack at this question is to understate the situation. Our counter-mix provides you, the player, with what we feel to be the most applicable unit types. If your most recent archaeological trip to Etruria has revealed something different, feel free to adjust.

Leaders have a variety of ratings, used to rate their Initiative and Command capabilities. These are discussed in 4.1.

Informational Markers, such as SHOCK MUST CHECK TQ, "#'s" (representing Cohesion Hits), ROUTED TQ=1, MISSILE LOW, etc., are used to record certain game functions, as discussed below.

2.25 Examples of Combat Units



2.3 CHARTS, TABLES AND THE DIE

The use of each chart and table is explained in the rules. The game uses a ten-sided die. The 0 is treated as a 0 (not a 10).

2.4 TERMINOLOGY

Knowledge of the following game terms will be useful for playing the game.

Active Leader: The leader who is giving orders to his troops at any given instant. Only one leader may be active at any one time.

Class: Subcategory within type, used to differentiate between various weapons systems within a type. *Example: HA (Hastati-class, within LG-type infantry).*

Cohesion: A unit's ability to remain in an organized, fighting formation. In the game this is measured in the form of Cohesion Hits (Hit/Hits for short).

Depletion: The loss of manpower that slightly reduces a unit's overall effectiveness.

DR: Die roll.

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